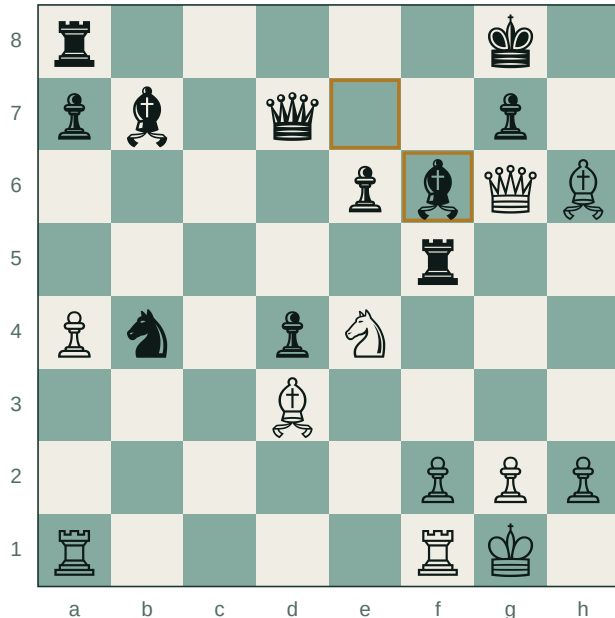


Interference tactics: White, move 23

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 22...Bf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Nxf6+ Rxf6 24. Qh7+ Kf8 25. Qh8+ Ke7 26. Qxg7+

23.Nxf6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on g8 and queen on d7. Recorded reply: **23...Rxf6**.

24.Qh7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **24...Kf8**.

25.Qh8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **25...Ke7**.

26.Qxg7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From g7 it attacks king on e7 and rook on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: pawn on g7.